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BREAKING NEWS AT CHICAGOTRIBUNE.COM

Trump freezes \$2.1B for transit

PRESIDENT CANCELS ENERGY PROJECTS: Amid a funding stalemate in Congress and a federal government shutdown, President Donald Trump’s planned termination of nearly \$8 billion for energy projects primarily in states that didn’t vote for him includes \$583 million in cuts to projects in Illinois. **Chicagoland, Page 3**

■ Hopes for a quick end to the shutdown faded Friday as Democrats refused to budge in a Senate vote and Trump readied plans to unleash layoffs and cuts across the government. **Nation & World**

Johnson mulls lawsuit as CTA Red Line Extension funds withheld amid campaign against blue cities

By A.D. Quig, Talia Soglin and Alice Yin
Chicago Tribune

Mayor Brandon Johnson said the city is considering legal action Friday after the White House froze \$2.1 billion in federal funding for two major Chicago transit projects over an investigation into racial preferences in contracting, the latest fusillade in President Donald Trump’s escalating campaign against blue cities and states during the U.S. government shutdown. Early Friday, White House budget director Russ Vought said the Trump administration will

withhold the money from the Chicago Transit Authority’s years-in-the-making Red Line Extension to the Far South Side as well as its ongoing Red and Purple Modernization project on the North Side. The announcement comes amid broader funding fights waged by the president on Democratic-led areas, including over what his administration has described as antiwhite discrimination. Vought posted on X Friday the money was “put on hold to ensure funding is not flowing via race-based contracting.”

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Dorval Carter Jr., then-president of the Chicago Transit Authority, at a news conference Jan. 10 heralding the final part of federal funding for the Red Line Extension project. **ANTONIO PEREZ/CHICAGO TRIBUNE**

With Noem, Bovino on site, agents put on show of strength in Broadview as elected officials, Democratic candidates call on Trump administration to allow inspection of processing center



Illinois State Police troopers detain a protester who refused to back up as a vehicle passed along Harvard Street near the U.S. Immigration and Customs Enforcement holding facility in Broadview on Friday. **STACEY WESCOTT/CHICAGO TRIBUNE**

Local, state police join in arresting ICE protesters

By Caroline Kubzansky, Madeline Buckley and Jake Sheridan
Chicago Tribune

Federal agents confronted hundreds of protesters for the fourth week straight outside the Broadview U.S. Immigration and Customs processing

center Friday, an exchange that at times had the look of a publicity stunt as masked men in military fatigues hung from the sides of an armored truck and waved to a jeering crowd as the media and local police officers looked on. Demonstrations at the west suburban site have grown heated in recent weeks as federal forces

have become more visible in downtown Chicago and arrests continue under President Donald Trump’s “Operation Midway Blitz.” Federal personnel have deployed baton rounds, tear gas and other less-lethal ammunition at protesters who try to block vehicles with their bodies, throw things and taunt the agents.

Several people were detained Friday but authorities did not use tear gas. Protesters began to gather at the intersection of 25th Avenue and Harvard Street around 6 a.m. Friday, carrying signs that read “And then they came for me” and

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LOGAN SQUARE GASSED: Agents released smoke canisters near a school on a busy Northwest Side street, and Ald. Jessie Fuentes was placed in handcuffs during an altercation. **Chicagoland, Page 4**

FEDS RESTRICT AIRSPACE: Sweeping restrictions on drone usage within the region are now in place, which the ACLU characterizes as an attempt to thwart oversight of ICE activity. **Chicagoland, Page 6**

Court denies bond for Madigan

Disgraced ex-speaker must report to prison in less than 2 weeks

By Jason Meisner
Chicago Tribune

A federal appeals court Friday denied bond for ex-House Speaker Michael Madigan pending his appeal on corruption charges, a decision that means Madigan will have to report to prison in less than two weeks to begin serving his 7½-year sentence. Madigan’s attorneys had argued he should remain free for a number of reasons, including that he’s not a flight risk and that there are complex legal issues that, if resolved in his favor, will require a new trial. That motion was denied in a one-page order from the 7th U.S. Circuit Court of Appeals. Lawyers for Madigan were not immediately available for comment. After a trial that stretched nearly four months, Madigan, 83, was convicted by a jury Feb. 12 on bribery conspiracy and other corruption charges. The jury found him guilty on 10 of 23 counts, including a multipronged scheme to accept and solicit payments from Commonwealth Edison to Madigan associates for do-nothing subcontracts. Madigan also was convicted on six out of seven counts — including wire fraud and Travel Act violations — regarding a plan to get then-Chicago Ald. Daniel Solis, who testified at length in the trial, appointed to a state board. The jury acquitted Madigan of several other schemes alleged in the indictment and deadlocked on other counts,

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Hamas accepts parts of truce as US urges end to bombing

By Wafaa Shurafa and Fatma Khaled
Associated Press

DEIR AL-BALAH, Gaza Strip — President Donald Trump ordered Israel on Friday to stop bombing the Gaza Strip after Hamas said

it had accepted some elements of his plan to end the nearly two-year war and return all the remaining hostages taken in the Oct. 7, 2023, attack. Hamas said it was willing to release the hostages and hand over power to other Palestinians, but

other aspects of the plan require further consultations among Palestinians. Senior Hamas officials suggested there were still major disagreements that required further negotiations. There was no immediate response from Israel, which is

largely shut down for the Jewish Sabbath, and Hamas’ response fell short of Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu’s demands that the group surrender and disarm. But Trump welcomed the Hamas statement, saying: “I believe they are ready for a lasting

PEACE.” “Israel must immediately stop the bombing of Gaza, so that we can get the Hostages out safely and quickly! Right now, it’s far too dangerous to do that. We are

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